

To: Asst. Prof. Francesco Pierri

Email: francesco.pierri@polimi.it

Subject: Application for PhD in Information Technology (DEIB) — Responsible AI / Computational Social Science — Ref [TODO: verify with user] — Nauval Zulfikar

Dear Asst. Prof. Pierri,

I am writing to express my interest in the PhD position within the DEIB — Data Science Lab at Politecnico di Milano, focusing on Responsible AI and Computational Social Science. I am eager to contribute to your research group, particularly in exploring the impact of large language models on digital ecosystems and social media integrity. I am available to start on 1 November 2026, aligning with the program's commencement.

Your paper, *[TODO: verify supervisor paper title via Google Scholar]*, has been particularly inspiring to me. The way it addresses the challenges of maintaining social media integrity in the age of generative AI resonates deeply with my professional experiences and aspirations.

My background in Business Analytics, with a First Class MSc from Aston University, has equipped me with a robust foundation in machine learning and natural language processing. During my tenure at the Public Works & Spatial Planning Department in Bandung, I spearheaded the development of automated ETL pipelines and self-service dashboards, achieving a 45% faster project delivery. This experience honed my skills in data governance and privacy practices, which are crucial for responsible AI development.

Furthermore, my MSc dissertation, *"Enhancing Supply Chain Information Sharing Systems Through Blockchain: Integrated Customer Reviews LLM Analysis,"* involved fine-tuning DeBERTa-v3 transformers for multi-tier supplier review data. This project underscored the importance of transparency and accountability in AI systems, aligning with the ethical considerations central to your research themes.

While my academic background is in Business Analytics rather than pure Computer Science, I am committed to bridging this gap. My ongoing training in NLP engineering and my practical experience in data science projects have prepared me to contribute effectively to your research group.

I have attached my CV and research statement for your review. Please let me know if there are additional documents or information you require.

Thank you for considering my application. I am enthusiastic about the opportunity to contribute to your team and am looking forward to the possibility of discussing my application further.

Sincerely,

Nauval Zulfikar

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